Stefan Herytash

sherytash.github.io

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Thyra Uth Thomsen, Head of Department, and the assessment committee
Department of Marketing
Copenhagen Business School
Solbjerg Plads 3
2000 Frederiksberg, Denmark

Application for the Tenure Track Assistant Professorship in Digital Marketing

Dear Thyra Uth Thomsen and members of the assessment committee,

I apply for the Tenure Track Assistant Professorship in Digital Marketing. I am an Assistant Professor at WU Vienna and a mathematician by training, from TU Wien and the University of Zurich. I took my PhD in Management, summa cum laude, at the Institute for Market-Based Management of LMU Munich, with a thesis on simulating human decision-making with large language models. From January to March 2027 I am a Visiting Scholar at the Scandinavian Consortium for Organizational Research at Stanford. I have taught thirteen courses at three business schools.

My solo-authored paper *When and How to Integrate AI Simulations into Behavioral Experimentation* (Revise & Resubmit at the **International Journal of Research in Marketing**) measures how far answers written by a language model can replace consumers. I simulate 70 treatment effects from 30 published marketing studies at the level of the instrument: each synthetic respondent completes the original questionnaire in one randomized condition. Simulated and human effects correlate at $r = .73$, but the simulated effects come out at about two-fifths of the human magnitudes. In a many-analyst study forthcoming in the same journal, I was one of 156 analyst teams that estimated brand price elasticities from the same household panel data; the team averages range from −7.3 to +3.1. *After the Fax Machine Burns* (Submitted to **Management Science** as a Discussion Paper) develops a publication system in which every submission is published on arrival and graded afterward.

Post-training Makes Large Language Models Less Human-like (Under Review; one of 79 authors) introduces the Psych-201 dataset and finds that the stage that turns a base model into an assistant reduces its alignment with human behaviour. *Synthetic Participants Reproduce Effects They Cannot Replace* shows that however many synthetic respondents a study adds, it still needs the share $1 - \rho^2$ of its human respondents, where ρ is the correlation between a human's response and the simulator's response for that human. SimuLabs, the engine behind these papers, will be made open source.

Platforms set thresholds that decide what the public sees. kununu, the largest employer-review and salary platform in the German-speaking labour market, shows a salary band only once enough employees have reported one; I am negotiating a multi-year data partnership with kununu to estimate what that threshold does to applicant flows. *The Matching Cost of Pay Transparency* asks whether pay transparency changes whom firms hire, with Revelio Labs data. A planned project uses the rating threshold of Airbnb's Superhost badge, an average of 4.8, to separate the badge from the quality it signals.

I have taught at LMU Munich, EM Lyon and WU Vienna. At WU I designed *Agentic AI in Strategy & Innovation*, in which students build and evaluate working agents; 95 % of the students recommend it. At LMU students rated me 10 out of 10 on average as instructor in *Project Management* and 9 out of 10 in *Marketing Management*. I teach the AI sessions of the *Vienna Innovation Program*, an executive-level programme for North American Master of Business Administration students, and this term the *Business Project* with Vienna Airport. I have supervised more than fifteen theses, serve on WU's appointment committee for the Full Professor of Strategic Management, and raised over €100,000 in research funding from industry partners at LMU.

I want to do this work at CBS for concrete reasons. My benchmark so far compares simulations with published results; CogLab and the experiments.cbs.dk participant pool would let me run the simulated and the human version of the same study side by side on Danish samples. Felix Eggers' work on language-model valuations and design priors for choice experiments is the closest to mine I know. The Digital Marketing Research Cluster works on online promotions and the platform economy, the two settings of my data work. Denmark adds data I cannot get in Austria: Statistics Denmark's linked employer-employee registers, on which I would test the hiring question of the Matching Cost paper, and firms I would like to approach, Salling Group for prices and promotions, Carlsberg for simulated and human pre-tests of brand decisions, and Trustpilot, whose ratings certify businesses the way the Superhost badge certifies hosts. My first Danish grant application would go to the Independent Research Fund Denmark's call Research on Artificial Intelligence, with a senior colleague from the department.

I will relocate to Copenhagen and be present in the department. I am eager to learn Danish. I would offer a master's elective on generative AI as a marketing research method, next to *Brand Analytics* in the EMF, and teach general marketing at bachelor's level and in executive programmes. I will explain what my research means for society in talks for practitioners and through the interactive figures of my papers on my website, take on department and CBS-wide tasks, and publish the data and code of each paper when it is published.

I can start on 1 September 2027. The application documents are also at `https://sherytash.github.io/for/cbs/`.

Sincerely,

Stefan Herytash